

## Module - 5

### Teams, Power & Politics and Conflicts & Negotiation in the workplace

Teams: Meaning of Teams, Advantages of Teams, Model of Team Effectiveness, Stages of Team Development. Power & Politics: Meaning, Sources, Contingencies of Power, Consequences of Power, Politics in organisation. Conflict and Negotiation in the workplace: Constructive & Relationship conflict, Conflict Process Model, Structural sources of Conflict Management, Resolving conflict through negotiation and Third-Party Conflict Resolution.

#### TEAMS

**Group** - to be a collection of two or more individuals who share norms and goals and have a common identity.

**Team** - is a special type of group, in which members hold themselves mutually accountable for a common purpose, goals, and approach. Ideally, they are willing to put their jobs and reputations in each other's hands.

A **team** is a group of individuals who come together to achieve a common goal. Unlike a group, a team has high levels of interdependence, collaboration, and shared responsibility. Teams function in various settings, including business, sports, healthcare, and education.

A team is defined as a group of people who perform interdependent tasks to work toward accomplishing a common mission or specific objective.

#### **Characteristics of a Team**

- Common purpose and goals
- Shared accountability and responsibility
- Collaboration and communication
- Complementary skills and expertise
- Mutual trust and respect

#### **Types of Teams**

- **Functional teams** – composed of individuals from the same department working toward shared objectives.
- **Cross-functional teams** – members from different departments collaborate on projects.

- **Self-managed teams** – operate without direct supervision and take ownership of their tasks.
- **Virtual teams** – team members work remotely and collaborate using digital tools.
- **Problem-solving teams** – formed to analyze and address specific challenges.

### Advantages for Organizations

- **Improved problem-solving** – different perspectives lead to better solutions.
- **Higher productivity** – collaboration enhances efficiency and output.
- **Innovation and creativity** – teams generate diverse ideas.
- **Better decision-making** – multiple viewpoints lead to informed choices.
- **Employee engagement** – teamwork fosters motivation and job satisfaction.

### Advantages for Employees

- **Skill development** – team members learn from each other.
- **Stronger relationships** – collaboration improves workplace bonding.
- **Greater work satisfaction** – teams provide support and recognition.
- **Reduced work stress** – shared responsibilities lighten the workload.

### Model of Team Effectiveness

A team effectiveness model is a framework that helps identify and improve how a team works together. These models can help teams achieve their goals and improve their performance.

Effective teams require the right combination of structure, leadership, communication, and support. Several models explain team effectiveness, such as the **mckinsey 7S model**, **GRPI model**, and **hackman's team effectiveness model**. One of the most widely used is **richard hackman's model**.

#### 1. McKinsey 7S Model

The **Mckinsey 7S model** was developed by **Tom Peters and Robert Waterman** in the 1980s at Mckinsey & company. It is a **strategic management model** that helps organizations assess and align different internal elements to improve performance.

The model consists of **seven interdependent factors**, which are categorized into:

#### Hard elements (tangible, easy to identify)

- **Strategy** – the organization's plan to achieve long-term goals.

- **Structure** – the way the organization is structured (hierarchy, teams, reporting).
- **Systems** – the processes and workflows that guide daily operations.

### Soft elements (intangible, difficult to measure)

- **Shared values** – the core values and corporate culture.
- **Style** – the leadership and management style.
- **Staff** – the workforce and their skills.
- **Skills** – the competencies and capabilities of employees.



### How it applies to teams

- Ensures all team members align with organizational goals (**strategy**).
- Helps define **clear roles and responsibilities** (**structure**).
- Promotes a strong team culture with **shared values** and an **effective leadership style**.
- Identifies skill gaps and training needs (**skills and staff**).

### Use in team development

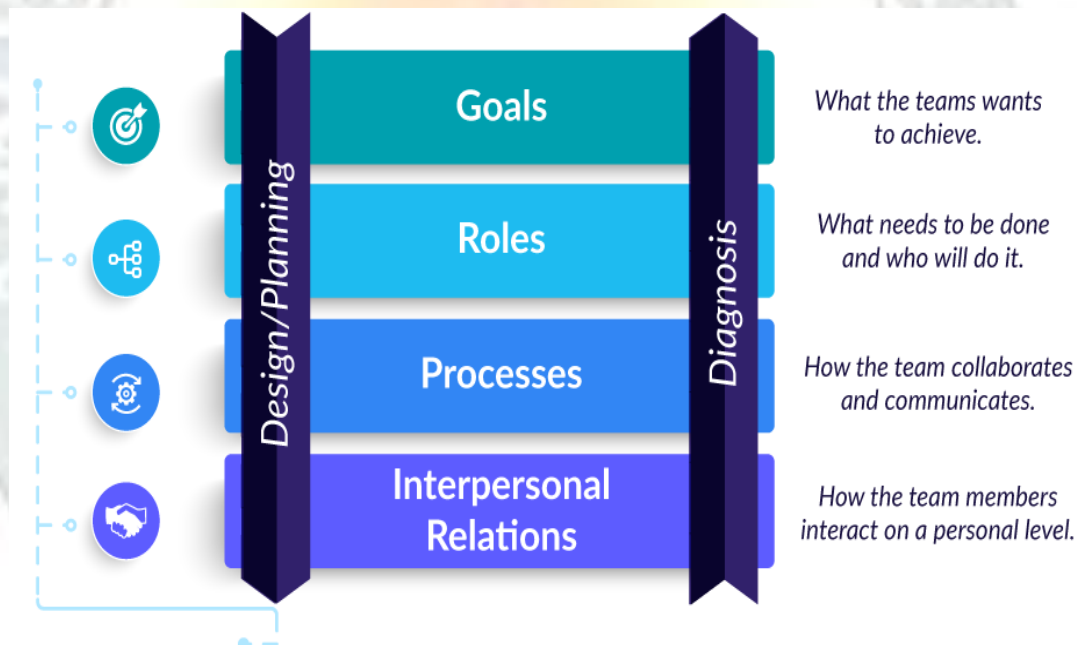
- A company facing **low team productivity** can use the **7S model** to diagnose issues:
- If the problem is **poor communication**, they may need to adjust their **systems**.
- If the team lacks motivation, the issue may lie in **style (leadership approach)** or **shared values**.
- If employees lack the right skills, they must focus on **staff and skills** improvement.

## 2. GRPI Model (Goals, Roles, Processes, and Interpersonal Relationships)

The **GRPI model** was developed by **Richard Beckhard** in 1972. It provides a **structured approach** to diagnose and improve team effectiveness by focusing on **four key dimensions**.

### The four components

- **Goals (G)** – the team's objectives must be clearly defined, measurable, and aligned with the organization's mission.
- **Roles (R)** – each team member should have a well-defined role and responsibility to avoid confusion.
- **Processes (P)** – the team must establish efficient workflows, decision-making frameworks, and communication mechanisms.
- **Interpersonal relationships (I)** – trust, collaboration, and conflict resolution are essential for smooth teamwork.



### How it applies to teams

- **Clear goals** ensure all team members are working toward the same objectives.
- **Defined roles** prevent duplication of efforts and confusion.
- **Efficient processes** improve team coordination and productivity.
- **Strong interpersonal relationships** enhance trust, reduce conflicts, and improve communication.



### Use in team development

- If a team **fails to meet deadlines**, the GRPI model can help:
- Check if the **goals** are clear and realistic.
- Ensure **roles** are well-defined to prevent overlapping responsibilities.
- Assess **processes** to improve efficiency and decision-making.
- Improve **interpersonal relationships** if conflicts are affecting teamwork.

### 3. Hackman's Team Effectiveness Model

Developed by **J. Richard Hackman**, this model focuses on the **key conditions** required for a team to be successful. It emphasizes the **importance of structure, leadership, and a supportive environment**.



### Five Key Factors for Team Effectiveness

- **Real team** – A well-defined team with clear membership, shared objectives, and interdependence.
- **Compelling direction** – a meaningful and challenging goal that motivates the team.
- **Enabling structure** – a well-organized structure with clear roles, processes, and norms.
- **Supportive context** – access to resources, rewards, and training to help the team succeed.
- **Expert coaching** – leaders or mentors provide guidance, motivation, and feedback.

### How it applies to teams

- Helps **align team members** around a common mission (**compelling direction**).
- Ensures the **right team composition** with **defined roles and processes** (**enabling structure**).
- Encourages organizations to **provide necessary resources** (**supportive context**).
- Stresses the importance of **mentorship and leadership** (**expert coaching**).

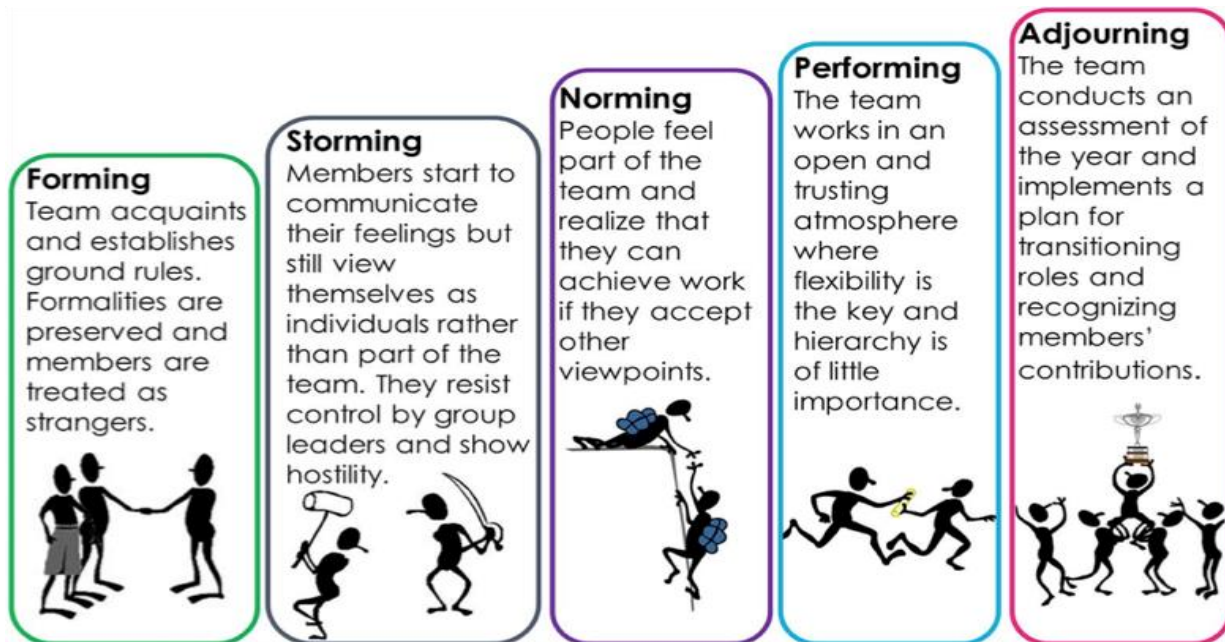
### Use case in team development

- If a **team lacks motivation and struggles to meet goals**, this model can help:
- Ensure they have a **clear purpose** (**compelling direction**).
- Improve **team structure and workflows** (**enabling structure**).
- Provide **training and incentives** (**supportive context**).
- Introduce **leadership development programs** (**expert coaching**).

### Stages of Team Development

The **stages of team development** were introduced by psychologist **Bruce Tuckman** in 1965. These stages describe how teams evolve and develop over time to become high-performing units. The five stages are:





### 1. Forming

- Team members get to know each other.
- Roles and responsibilities are unclear.
- Members rely on the leader for guidance.
- There may be excitement, curiosity, or anxiety.

### 2. Storming

- Conflicts and disagreements arise as roles are established.
- Differences in opinions and working styles lead to friction.
- Power struggles may occur.
- The leader must help resolve conflicts and keep the team focused.

### 3. Norming

- Team members start to cooperate and collaborate.
- Rules, values, and expectations become clearer.
- Trust and respect develop among members.
- Productivity increases as the team starts working effectively.

#### 4. Performing

- The team functions efficiently and independently.
- High levels of trust, collaboration, and productivity.
- Minimal supervision is needed.
- Focus is on achieving goals and delivering results.

#### 5. Adjourning (mourning) (added in 1977)

- The project or task is completed.
- Team members may feel a sense of accomplishment or sadness as they part ways.
- Reflection and recognition of contributions occur.

### **POWER & POLITICS IN ORGANIZATIONS**

**Power:** power is the ability of an individual or a group to influence others' behavior to achieve desired outcomes, even in the face of resistance. In an organizational context, power is used to control resources, shape decisions, and influence policies.

**Politics in Organizations:** Organizational politics refers to activities undertaken by individuals or groups to acquire, develop, and use power to achieve personal or organizational goals. Politics often involve informal strategies, networking, lobbying, and influence tactics.

#### **Sources of Power**

Power can be categorized into **formal (positional) power** and **personal power**:

##### **A. Formal power (based on position)**

- **Legitimate power** – derived from an official position or authority (e.G., CEO, manager).
- **Reward power** – based on the ability to provide rewards (e.G., Promotions, bonuses).
- **Coercive power** – comes from the ability to impose punishments (e.G., Demotions, threats).

##### **B. Personal power (based on individual attributes)**

- **Expert power** – based on knowledge, skills, or expertise (e.G., IT specialist, consultant).
- **Referent power** – stemming from admiration, respect, or charisma (e.G., Influential leaders like elon musk, steve jobs).



### C. Additional sources of power

- **Information power** – access to critical information that others do not have.
- **Connection power** – influence gained from networks and relationships.

### Contingencies of Power

Even if someone has power, their effectiveness depends on four key contingencies:

- **Substitutability** – power is stronger when there are no substitutes for the resource or skill provided.
- **Centrality** – power increases when an individual's role is crucial to the organization.
- **Discretion** – having decision-making freedom enhances power.
- **Visibility** – power is more effective when others recognize and acknowledge it.

### Consequences of Power

Power can have **positive and negative** impacts on individuals and organizations:

#### Positive consequences:

- ✓ Encourages efficiency and decision-making.
- ✓ Helps in achieving organizational goals.
- ✓ Can be used for motivation and leadership.
- ✓ Leads to better resource allocation.

#### Negative consequences:

- ✗ Can lead to corruption and abuse of authority.
- ✗ Creates conflicts and unhealthy competition.
- ✗ Leads to resistance and dissatisfaction among employees.
- ✗ Can promote favoritism and unethical behavior.

### Politics in Organizations

Organizational politics refers to the informal use of power and influence tactics to achieve personal or professional goals. Organizational politics refer to the use of power and influence within an organization to attain personal or group objectives, often at the expense of the organization's goals. This can include actions like forming alliances, using information selectively, creating coalitions, and engaging in power struggles.

**Reasons for organizational politics:**

- **Scarcity of resources** – employees compete for limited resources like promotions and budget allocations.
- **Unclear decision-making processes** – when policies are unclear, people use influence to get ahead.
- **Diverse interests** – different employees have conflicting goals, leading to political behavior.
- **Personal ambitions** – individuals engage in politics to climb the corporate ladder.

**Political tactics used in organizations:**

- **Building alliances and coalitions** – gaining support from influential people.
- **Impression management** – creating a positive image through networking.
- **Blaming or scapegoating** – shifting responsibility to others.
- **Control of information** – withholding or manipulating information to gain an advantage.

**Managing organizational politics:**

- Encourage **transparency** in decision-making.
- Promote **ethical leadership** to set a positive example.
- Establish **clear rules and policies** to reduce ambiguity.
- Foster **open communication** to minimize conflicts.

**CONFLICT AND NEGOTIATION IN THE WORKPLACE**

**Conflict:** Conflict is a situation in which individuals or groups perceive a clash of interests, values, actions, or goals. It can arise due to differences in opinions, competition for resources, or misunderstandings.

**Types of conflict:**

- **Task conflict** – disagreements about work-related tasks.
- **Process conflict** – disputes over how work should be done.
- **Relationship conflict** – personal clashes based on emotions, values, or personality differences.

**Negotiation:** Negotiation is a discussion between two or more parties to resolve a conflict by reaching a mutually acceptable agreement. It involves communication, persuasion, and compromise.

### **Constructive & Relationship Conflict**

#### **A. Constructive conflict (functional conflict)**

- Encourages diverse perspectives and creativity.
- Leads to better decision-making and problem-solving.
- Increases innovation by challenging the status quo.
- Improves team performance when managed effectively.

#### **B. Relationship conflict (dysfunctional conflict)**

- Arises from personal differences, emotions, or personality clashes.
- Distracts from work and reduces productivity.
- Leads to stress, resentment, and workplace toxicity.
- Can result in team breakdown and employee turnover.

### **Conflict Process Model**

The **conflict process model** explains how conflict develops in five stages:

#### **Stage 1: sources of conflict (antecedent conditions)**

- Differences in goals or values.
- Scarce resources.
- Ambiguous roles or unclear communication.

#### **Stage 2: perceived conflict**

- Awareness of a disagreement or problem.
- No direct action yet, but tension starts building.

#### **Stage 3: felt conflict (emotional involvement)**

- Personal emotions like anger, frustration, or stress arise.
- The conflict becomes intense and harder to manage.

**Stage 4: manifest conflict (conflict becomes visible)**

- Open expressions of disagreement (arguments, complaints, passive-aggressive behavior).
- Workplace disruptions occur.

**Stage 5: conflict aftermath**

- If resolved effectively → stronger relationships, improved processes.
- If unresolved → continued resentment, further conflicts.

**Structural Sources of Conflict**

Conflict in organizations often arises due to structural issues, including:

- 1. Goal incompatibility:** different departments or individuals pursue conflicting goals (e.g., Sales wants to maximize revenue, finance wants to minimize costs).
- 2. Limited resources:** employees or teams compete for scarce resources like budget, promotions, or workspace.
- 3. Interdependence:** the more teams depend on each other, the higher the chances of conflict (e.g., If one team's delay affects another's work).
- 4. Communication barriers:** misunderstandings due to poor communication lead to unnecessary conflicts.
- 5. Differences in values & cultures:** employees from diverse backgrounds may have different work ethics, decision-making styles, or cultural norms.
- 6. Power & status differences:** conflicts arise when employees feel that decisions favor those with higher authority or influence.

**Resolving conflict through negotiation**

Negotiation is the key tool for resolving conflicts constructively.

**Types of negotiation strategies:**

- **Distributive bargaining ("win-lose")**
  - Competitive approach where one party gains at the expense of the other.
  - Used in salary negotiations or legal disputes.
- **Integrative bargaining ("win-win")**
  - Collaborative approach to find mutually beneficial solutions.



- Focuses on problem-solving rather than competition.
- **Compromise ("give-and-take")**
  - Each party gives up something to reach an agreement.
  - Works when both parties have equal power.
- **Avoidance ("lose-lose")**
  - Ignoring or withdrawing from the conflict instead of resolving it.
  - Useful when the issue is trivial but harmful in the long run.
- **Accommodation ("let them win")**
  - One party gives in to maintain harmony.
  - Suitable when the issue is not important to one party.

### Steps in effective negotiation

- ✓ **Preparation** – Define goals, gather facts, and understand the other party's position.
- ✓ **Exchange Information** – Share viewpoints and clarify misunderstandings.
- ✓ **Bargaining** – Present arguments, make concessions, and reach agreements.
- ✓ **Closing & Agreement** – Confirm mutual understanding and document the resolution.

### Third-Party Conflict Resolution

When negotiation fails, organizations use third-party interventions.

#### 1. Mediation

- A neutral third party **facilitates** discussions to help both sides reach a voluntary agreement.
- The mediator **does not impose** a solution but helps clarify misunderstandings.

#### 2. Arbitration

- A neutral third party **makes a binding decision** after hearing both sides.
- Used in labor disputes, legal conflicts, and corporate disagreements.

#### 3. Inquisition

- A higher authority (e.g., Manager) **takes control of the process, investigates, and makes a final decision.**
- Quick but may be perceived as unfair.

#### 4. Collaboration (problem-solving approach)

- Both parties **work together** to find a solution that satisfies all.
- Best for maintaining long-term relationships.

Conflict is natural in any workplace, but when managed effectively, it **leads to innovation and growth**. By understanding the **conflict process model, sources of conflict, negotiation strategies, and third-party resolutions**, organizations can **transform conflicts into opportunities for collaboration and success**.

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